residents received deliveries more reliably and sustainably, supporting both daily living and emergency preparedness.

While the Parcelcopter program has not yet transitioned to nationwide deployment due to regulatory limitations and operational cost considerations, it remains a landmark example of how UAV logistics can strengthen supply resilience in remote areas. The DHL experience provides valuable insights into infrastructure design (SkyHubs), hybrid drone engineering, community acceptance strategies, and integration with national airspace systems. The lessons learned from Parcelcopter continue to influence emerging UAV cargo networks across Europe and beyond.

8.10.10 Case Study: CNN – drone-based news reporting and crisis coverage

CNN has been a global pioneer in the professional integration of UAVs into broadcast journalism. In 2016, the network formally launched CNN Air, a dedicated drone operations unit designed to enhance aerial reporting capabilities across news, documentary, and investigative programing. The goal was to improve situational awareness, visual accuracy, and narrative clarity during fast-evolving news events. Drones quickly became essential in covering natural disasters, humanitarian emergencies, protest movements, and conflict zones, where conventional ground-based or helicopter-based reporting was limited by access, cost, or safety conditions.

During hurricanes along the US coastline, drones enabled CNN reporters to capture real-time high-resolution imagery of damaged neighborhoods, flooded regions, and affected infrastructure, offering a wider context that helped emergency agencies and the public assess the severity of the situa tion. Similarly, during wildfire seasons in California, CNN’s drone footage revealed fire spread patterns, evacuation challenges, and structural damage, supporting both crisis communication and relief coordination. These cases